



Technical Writing

IV SEMESTER

HS-204



Technical Writing Course Objectives

- To improve grammar and sentence structure and build vocabulary.
- To understand how to write different types of writings.
- To understand how to compose different types of business documents
- To understand business ethics and develop soft skills



Technical Writing Course Outcomes (CO)

- Ability to improve grammar and sentence structure and build vocabulary.
- Ability to write different types of writings with clarity.
- Ability to write different types of business documents.
- To understand business ethics and develop soft skills
- Ability to apply business ethics and enhance personality



Technical Writing

Course Outcomes (CO)

Course Outcomes (CO to Programme Outcomes (PO) Mapping (scale 1: low, 2: Medium, 3: High)

CO/PO	PO01	PO02	PO03	PO04	PO05	PO06	PO07	PO08	PO09	PO10	PO11	PO12
CO1	-	-	-	-	-	1	-	-	-	3	-	-
CO2	-	-	-	-	-	1	-	-	-	3	-	-
CO3	-	-	-	-	-	1	-	-	-	3	-	-
CO4	-	-	-	-	-	1	-	3	-	3	-	-

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Subject: Technical Writing, Instructor: Dr. Sandeep Sharma



UNIT 1

Grammar and Vocabulary--- Types of sentences (simple, complex and compound) and use of connectives in sentences, Subject-verb agreement, Comprehension, Synonyms and Antonyms, Homophones and Homonyms, Word Formation: Prefixes and Suffixes, Indianism, Misappropriation and Redundant Words, Question Tags and Short Responses.



UNIT 2

Writing Styles -- Expository, Explanatory, Descriptive, Argumentative and Narrative. Precis writing, Visual Aids in Technical Writing, Plagiarism and Language Sensitivity in Technical Writing, Dialogue Writing, Proposals: Purpose and Types.



UNIT 3

Letters at the Workplace—letter writing: Request, Sales, Enquiry, Order and Complaint. Job Application---Resume and Cover letter, Difference between Resume and CV, Preparation for Interview. Meeting Documentation--- Notice, Memorandum, Circular, Agenda, Office Order and Minutes of meeting, Writing Instructions.



UNIT 4

Ethics and Personality Development The Role of Ethics in Business Communication—Ethical Principles, Time Management, Self-Analysis through SWOT and JOHARI Window, Emotional Intelligence and Leadership Skills, Team Building, Career Planning, Self Esteem



Types of sentences (simple, complex and compound)

A sentence may be one of four kinds, depending upon the number and type(s) of clauses it contains.

An **independent clause** contains a subject, a verb, and a complete thought.

Example : I wrote my first novel Last year.

A **dependent clause** contains a subject and a verb, but no complete thought.

Example : After I wrote my first novel Last year.



Types of sentences (simple, complex and compound)

A **SIMPLE SENTENCE** has one independent clause.

Tom reads Novels

Tom reads Newspapers

Tom reads Novels and Newspapers (Compound direct object)

Tom reads and enjoys novels (Compound verb)

Tom and Harry read novels (Compound Subject)

Tom and Harry read and enjoy novels and newspapers (Compound subject, verb and direct objects)



Types of sentences (**simple**, complex and compound)

Punctuation note: NO commas separate **two** compound elements (subject, verb, direct object, indirect object, subjective complement, etc.) in a simple sentence.



Types of sentences (simple, complex and **compound**)

A **COMPOUND SENTENCE** has two independent clauses joined by

- A. a coordinating conjunction (*for, and, nor, but, or, yet, so*),
- B. a conjunctive adverb (e.g. *however, therefore*), or
- C. a semicolon alone.

Example:

- A. Tom reads novels, but Jack reads comics.
- B. Tom reads novels; however, jack reads comics.
- C. Tom reads novels; his friend reads comics



Types of sentences (simple, complex and compound)

Punctuation patterns (to match A, B, and C above):

A. Independent clause, coordinating conjunction independent clause.

B. Independent clause; conjunctive adverb, independent clause.

C. Independent clause; independent clause.



Types of sentences (simple, complex and compound)

A **COMPLEX SENTENCE** has one dependent clause (headed by a subordinating conjunction or a relative pronoun) joined to an independent clause.

Examples :

- A. Although Tom reads novels, Jack reads comics.
- B. Jack reads comics although Tom reads novels.
- C. Jack smith, who reads comics, rarely reads novels.
- D. People who read comics rarely read novels.



Types of sentences (simple, complex and compound)

Punctuation patterns (to match A, B, C and D above):

- A. Dependent clause, independent clause
- B. Independent clause dependent clause
- C. Independent, nonessential dependent clause, clause.
- D. Independent essential dependent clause clause.



Types of sentences (**compound-complex**)

A **COMPOUND-COMPLEX SENTENCE** has two independent clauses joined to one or more dependent clauses.

Examples: (Dependent clause in bold)

While Tom reads novels, Jack reads comics, but Sam reads only magazines.

Tom reads novels, but Jack reads comics **because books are too difficult**.

Jack, **who reads comics**, rarely reads novels; Tom enjoys novels

People **who read comics** rarely read novels; they often find books difficult.



Quiz

- While the people came, Rachel sneaked in through the window.
 - A. Simple
 - B. Compound
 - C. Complex
 - D. Not sure
- I want to go to the gym, yet I don't go there.
 - A. Simple
 - B. Compound
 - C. Complex
 - D. Not sure



Quiz

- Maya should not handle this situation.
 - A. Simple
 - B. Compound
 - C. Complex
 - D. Not sure
- Paul and Stephen never attend the party.
 - A. Simple
 - B. Compound
 - C. Complex
 - D. Not sure



Quiz

- Since it's a dark night, we should stay here.
 - A. Simple
 - B. Compound
 - C. Complex
 - D. Not sure
- Although he searched everywhere, Mr. Brooks could not find the keys to the computer lab.
 - A. Simple
 - B. Compound
 - C. Complex
 - D. Not sure



Quiz

- What is a sentence that has independent clause and at least one dependent clause called?
 - A. Simple
 - B. Compound
 - C. Complex
 - D. Not sure
- Sarah and Ashley giggled and whispered all night.
 - A. Simple
 - B. Compound
 - C. Complex
 - D. Not sure



Quiz

- A single independent clause is
 - A. Simple
 - B. Compound
 - C. Complex
 - D. Not sure
- Although he ate food, he was still hungry.
 - A. Simple
 - B. Compound
 - C. Complex
 - D. Not sure



Answer

1. Complex
2. Compound
3. Simple
4. Simple
5. Not sure
6. Complex
7. Complex
8. Simple
9. Simple
10. complex



Use of Connectives

Connectives can be one word or a phrase.

The purpose of the words or ideas to be connected will determine the type of connective used.

Connectives can be also used as starters of a paragraph or clause, whereas conjunctions generally cannot.



Basic Rules For Using Connectives

The different types of connectives are not interchangeable.

The sentences/ideas being connected must be related.

Connectives are usually used only once in a sentence

Connectives Used for Different Purposes

Adding	Cause & Effect	Sequencing	Contrasting
and, also, as well as, moreover, furthermore, besides, in addition, etc.	because, so, therefore, thus, consequently, as a result of, etc.	next, then, first, second,... finally, meanwhile, after, etc.	whereas, instead of, alternatively, otherwise, unlike, on the other hand, in contrast, etc.
Qualifying	Emphasizing	Illustrating	Comparing
however, although, unless, except, if, as long as, apart from, yet, despite, etc.	above all, in particular, especially, significantly, indeed, notably, most of all	for example, such as, for instance, as revealed by, in the case of, as shown by, etc.	equally, in the same way, like, similarly, likewise, as with, as compared with, etc.



Suggested Teaching Strategies

Provide grids as scaffolds to sort and identify connectives.

Play cooperative games to practice skills and meta-language.

Model how to connect different sentences into a cohesive text using the appropriate connective, then ask students to connect sentences on their own or in small groups when working with English language learners (ELLs).

Prior to the lesson, expose students to the connectives found in the text you will be using.



Examples of Using Connectives

The teacher liked my grades, **in particular** my 100% grade for writing. (emphasizing)

I can go out with friends, **as long as** I am home by 9:00 p.m. (qualifying)

The film is long and boring, **whereas** the book is thrilling and well written. (contrasting)

Class debates are interesting, **for example** the one about the Civil War. (illustrating)

Today, we completed the chapter on cells; **therefore**, we will have a quiz on this topic tomorrow.



Activity

Complete the blanks with the appropriate connective from the list at the bottom:

1. I put a note beside his cereal bowl; _____, he would not notice it.
2. She married him _____ he was extremely rich.
3. You should study more, _____ you might fail your exams.
4. Sarah was not smiling. _____, Sarah was already lonely.
5. I will go for a walk if the weather is nice; _____, you can ride your bike.

- *(since, because, furthermore, otherwise, likewise)*



Subject-verb agreement

Basic Rule. A singular subject (*she, Bill, car*) takes a singular verb (*is, goes, shines*), whereas a plural subject takes a plural verb.

- **Example:** *The list of items is / are on the desk.*
If you know that *list* is the subject, then you will choose *is* for the verb.
- **Exceptions to the Basic rule:**
 - a. The first person pronoun *I* takes a plural verb (*I go, I drive*).
 - b. The basic form of the verb is used after certain main verbs such as *watch, see, hear, feel, help, let, and make*. (*He watched Ronaldo score the winning goal*).



Subject-verb agreement

- **Rule 1.** A subject will come before a phrase beginning with *of*. This is a key rule for understanding subjects. The word *of* is the culprit in many, perhaps most, subject-verb mistakes.

Hasty writers, speakers, readers, and listeners might miss the all-too-common mistake in the following sentence:

- **Incorrect:** *A bouquet of yellow roses lend color and fragrance to the room.*
- **Correct:** *A bouquet of yellow roses lends . . . (bouquet lends, not roses lend)*



Subject-verb agreement

- **Rule 2.** Two singular subjects connected by *or*, *either / or*, or *neither / nor* require a singular verb.
- **Examples:**
 - My aunt or my uncle **is** arriving by train today.*
 - Neither Juan nor Carmen **is** available.*
 - Either Kiana or Casey **is** helping today with stage decorations.*



Subject-verb agreement

- **Rule 3.** The verb in an *or*, *either/or*, or *neither/nor* sentence agrees with the noun or pronoun closest to it.
- **Examples:**
Neither the plates nor the serving bowl goes on that shelf.
Neither the serving bowl nor the plates go on that shelf.
- This rule can lead to bumps in the road. For example, if *I* is one of two (or more) subjects, it could lead to this odd sentence:
- **Awkward:** *Neither she, my friends, nor I am going to the festival.*
- If possible, it's best to reword such grammatically correct but awkward sentences.
- **Better:**
Neither she, I, nor my friends are going to the festival.
OR
She, my friends, and I are not going to the festival.



Subject-verb agreement

- **Rule 4.** As a general rule, use a plural verb with two or more subjects when they are connected by *and*.
- **Example:** A car and a bike are my means of transportation.
- But note these exceptions:
- **Exceptions:**
 - Breaking and entering is against the law.
 - The bed and breakfast was charming.
- In those sentences, *breaking and entering* and *bed and breakfast* are compound nouns.



Subject-verb agreement

- **NOTE**
- Some think it is incorrect to place a personal pronoun first in a multi-subject sentence.
- *Examples:*
I, my dad, and my step-mom are going to the movies.
She and Orville bought a dog.
- While not grammatically incorrect per se, it is a courtesy to place the pronoun last, except when awkward to do so as shown under **Rule 3** above.



Subject-verb agreement

- **Rule 5a.** Sometimes the subject is separated from the verb by such words as *along with*, *as well as*, *besides*, *not*, etc. These words and phrases are not part of the subject. Ignore them and use a singular verb when the subject is singular.
- **Examples:**
The politician, along with the newsmen, is expected shortly.
Excitement, as well as nervousness, is the cause of her shaking.



Subject-verb agreement

- **Rule 5b.** Parentheses are not part of the subject.
- **Example:** *Joe (and his trusty mutt) was always welcome.*
- **Rule 6.** In sentences beginning with *here* or *there*, the true subject follows the verb.
- **Examples:**
There are four hurdles to jump.
There is a high hurdle to jump.
Here are the keys.



Subject-verb agreement

- **Rule 7.** Use a singular verb with distances, periods of time, sums of money, etc., when considered as a unit.

- **Examples:**

*Three miles **is** too far to walk.*

*Five years **is** the maximum sentence for that offense.*

*Ten dollars **is** a high price to pay.*

BUT

*Ten dollars (i.e., dollar bills) **were** scattered on the floor.*



Subject-verb agreement

- **Rule 8a.** With words that indicate portions—e.g., *a lot*, *a majority*, *some*, *all*—Rule 1 given earlier in this section is reversed, and we are guided by the noun after *of*. If the noun after *of* is singular, use a singular verb. If it is plural, use a plural verb.
- **Examples:**
 - A lot of the pie has disappeared.*
 - A lot of the pies have disappeared.*



Subject-verb agreement

*Fifty percent of the **pie** has disappeared.*

*Fifty percent of the **pies** have disappeared.*

*A third of the **city** is unemployed.*

*A third of the **people** are unemployed.*

*All of the **pie** is gone.*

*All of the **pies** are gone.*

*Some of the **pie** is missing.*

*Some of the **pies** are missing.*

.



Subject-verb agreement

- **Rule 8b.** With **collective nouns** such as *group, jury, family, audience, population*, the verb might be singular or plural, depending on the writer's intent.
- **Examples:**
*All of my **family** has arrived OR have arrived.*
*Most of the **jury** is here OR are here.*
*A third of the **population** was not in favor OR were not in favor of the bill.*



Subject-verb agreement

- **Rule 9.** The word *were* replaces *was* in sentences that express a wish or are contrary to fact:
- **Example:** *If Joe **were** here, you'd be sorry.*
- Shouldn't *Joe* be followed by *was*, not *were*, given that *Joe* is singular? But *Joe* isn't actually here, so we say *were*, not *was*. The sentence demonstrates the **subjunctive mood**, which is used to express a hypothetical, wishful, imaginary, or factually contradictory thought. The subjunctive mood pairs singular subjects with what we usually think of as plural verbs.
- **Examples:**
*I wish it **were** Friday.*
*She requested that he **raise** his hand.*
*The foreman demanded that Joe **wear** safety goggles.*



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Subject-verb agreement Quiz

For each of the following, choose the sentence in which the subject and verb agree

1. Every one of the shirts has a green collar.

Every one of the shirts have a green collar.

2. This singer, along with a few others, play the harmonica on stage.

This singer, along with a few others, plays the harmonica on stage.



Subject-verb agreement Quiz

For each of the following, choose the sentence in which the subject and verb agree

3. Sandals and towels are essential gear for a trip to the beach.

Sandals and towels is essential gear for a trip to the beach.

4. The president or the vice president are speaking today.

The president or the vice president is speaking today.

5. Either Cassie or Marie pays the employees this afternoon.

Either Cassie or Marie pay the employees this afternoon.



Subject-verb agreement Quiz

For each of the following, choose the sentence in which the subject and verb agree

6. The coat or the hats are in that closet.

The coat or the hats is in that closet.

7. Neither she nor I is getting the lunch special.

Neither she nor I am getting the lunch special.

Neither she nor I are getting the lunch special.

8. Everybody at the party was enjoying the food.

Everybody at the party were enjoying the food.



Subject-verb agreement Quiz

1. Correct Answer: A Every one of the shirts has a green collar.
 - Explanation: The pronoun *one* is singular and requires singular verbs. Do not be misled by the object of the preposition.
2. Correct Answer: B This singer, along with a few others, plays the harmonica on stage.
 - Explanation: Sometimes the subject is separated from the verb by words such as *along with*, *as well as*, *besides*, or *not*. Ignore these expressions when determining whether to use a singular or plural verb.



Subject-verb agreement Quiz

- 3. Correct Answer: A Sandals and towels are essential gear for a trip to the beach.
- Explanation: two subjects connected by *and* require a plural verb.
- 4. Correct Answer: B The president or the vice president is speaking today.
- Explanation: two singular subjects connected by *or* require a singular verb.



Subject-verb agreement Quiz

5. Correct Answer: A Either Cassie or Marie pays the employees this afternoon.

- Explanation: two singular subjects connected by *or*, *either/or*, or *neither/nor* require a singular verb.

6. Correct Answer: A The coat or the hats are in that closet.

Explanation: when a singular and plural subject are connected by *or*, *either/or*, or *neither/nor*, the verb agrees with the subject closer to it.



Subject-verb agreement Quiz

7. Correct Answer: B Neither she nor I am getting the lunch special.

- Explanation: see Explanation 6. In this case, the verb must agree with the subject pronoun "I."
- 8. Correct Answer: A Everybody at the party was enjoying the food.
- Explanation: the pronoun *everybody* is singular and requires singular verbs.



Comprehension

The casual horrors and real disasters are thrown at newspaper reader without discrimination. In the contemporary arrangements for circulating the news, an important element, evaluation is always weak and often wanting entirely. There is no point anywhere along the line somewhere someone put his foot down for certain and says, "This is important and that does not amount to row of beans; deserves no ones attention, and should travel the wires no farther". The junk is dressed up to look as meaningful as the real news.



Comprehension

Q. 1 Evaluation of news would imply

- less dependence on modern systems of communication
- more careful analysis of each news story and its value
- separating beans from junk
- discriminating horrors from disasters



Comprehension

Q. 2 The writer of the above passage

- seems to be happy with the contemporary arrangements for circulating news
- is shocked by the casual stories about horrors and disasters reported in the newspapers
- wants better evaluation of news before publication
- wants to put his foot down on news stories



Comprehension

Q. 3 In the above passage, the phrase "amounts to a row of beans" means that the news

- is weak and often wanting entirely
- deserves no one's attention
- should travel the wires
- is junk dressed up as real news



Comprehension

Q. 4 Newspapers lack a sense of discrimination because

- they do not separate the real news from mere sensationalism
- they have to accept whatever is received on the wires
- limited manpower makes serious evolution impossible
- people don't see the difference between 'junk' and 'real' news



Comprehension

Q. 5 The passage implies that

- there has to be censorship on newspapers
- there is no point in having censorship
- newspapers always dress up junk to look meaningful
- one has to be strict in selecting news items



Comprehension

1. B
2. C
3. B
4. A
5. C



Synonyms and Antonyms

- **synonyms**

a word or phrase that has the same meaning as another word or phrase in the same language

- **antonyms**

a word that means the opposite of another word



Synonyms Example

- CORPULENT

Lean

Gaunt

Emaciated

Obese

- BRIEF

Limited

Small

Little

Short



Antonyms Example

- ENORMOUS

Soft

Average

Tiny

Weak

- COMMISSIONED

Started

Closed

Finished

Terminated



Homophones and Homonyms

Homophones are words or groups with the same sound but differ in the word's meaning.

Homonyms have the same spelling or said but different meanings



Homophones Example

- I saw a of cows in the field.

group

herd

swarm

flock

Herd - a group of animals (especially mammals).

Swarm - a group of flying insects.

Flock - a group of birds.

Hence herd is related to cow.



Homophones and Homonyms

	Same Spelling	Same Pronunciation	Same Meaning
Homophones	X	√	X
Homonyms	√	√	X



Homophones Example

It's always nice to learn a Sport. (new, Knew)

The team wear a Uniform. (blue, blew)

The players the rules of the game very well. (new, knew)

To, too, two



Homonyms Example

Fair (an event)

Fair (quite good)

Lie (to rest in a flat position)

Lie (to say something you know is not true)

Kind (helpful)

Kind (a type)

Bear (animal)

Bear (to tolerate)



Word Formation: Prefixes and Suffixes

A prefix is a word part added to the beginning of a word that changes the word's meaning.

A suffix is a word part added to the end of a word that changes the word's meaning.



Word Formation: Prefixes Examples

Prefix	Meaning	Examples
<i>re-</i>	again or back	restructure, revisit, reappear, rebuild, refinance
<i>dis-</i>	reverses the meaning of the verb	disappear, disallow, disarm, disconnect, discontinue
<i>over-</i>	too much	overbook, oversleep, overwork
<i>un-</i>	reverses the meaning of the verb	unbend, uncouple, unfasten
<i>mis-</i>	badly or wrongly	mislead, misinform, misidentify
<i>out-</i>	more or better than others	outperform, outbid
<i>be-</i>	make or cause	befriend, belittle
<i>co-</i>	together	co-exist, co-operate, co-own
<i>de-</i>	do the opposite of	devalue, deselect
<i>fore-</i>	earlier, before	foreclose, foresee
<i>inter-</i>	between	interact, intermix, interface
<i>pre-</i>	before	pre-expose, prejudge, pretest
<i>sub-</i>	under/below	subcontract, subdivide
<i>trans-</i>	across, over	transform, transcribe, transplant
<i>under-</i>	not enough	underfund, undersell, undervalue, underdevelop



Word Formation: Suffixes Examples

Suffix	Example
<i>-ise</i>	stabilise, characterise, symbolise, visualise, specialise
<i>-ate</i>	differentiate, liquidate, pollinate, duplicate, fabricate
<i>-fy</i>	classify, exemplify, simplify, justify
<i>-en</i>	awaken, fasten, shorten, moisten



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Indianism,

When someone approaches you with a query, and your reply begins with the phrase “do one thing,” you're doing it wrong. “Do one thing” is a phrase that does not make sense. It is an Indianism.

Indianism refers to a word or phrase which is a characteristic of Indian English. This may also refer to the way a sentence has been structured as if it was literally translated from an Indian language to English. Most Indians are bilingual (at the very least), speaking their mother tongue as well as English.



Misappropriation and Redundant Words

Redundancy is the needless repetition of words, phrases, sentences, paragraphs or ideas.

Redundancy is when we use two or more words together that mean the same thing, for example, 'adequate enough'. We also say something is redundant when a modifier's meaning is contained in the word it modifies, for example, 'merge together'.



Misappropriation and Redundant Words

- Common redundancies to avoid in business writing:
- In my opinion, I... (Use: I...)
- Collaborated together (Use: collaborated)
- Past experience (Use: experience)
- The reason why (Use: reason)
- Plus in addition (Use: in addition)

Misappropriation and Redundant Words

Be concise!

Instead of...	Try saying...
12 midnight	Midnight
12 noon	Noon
a total of 14 birds	14 birds
Biography of her life	Biography
Circle around	Circle
Close proximity	Proximity
Each and every	Each
End result	Result
Exactly the same	The same
Free gift	Gift
In spite of the fact that	Although
In the event that	If
New innovations	Innovations
One and the same	The same
Period of four days	Four days
Repeat again	Repeat
Revert back	Revert
Shorter/longer in length	Shorter/Longer
Summarise briefly	Summarise



Question Tags and Short Responses

- Your sister sings well, doesn't she?
- Samuel passed the test, didn't he?
- She recognized him, didn't she?
- Someone wanted a drink, didn't they?
- You like mushrooms, don't you?
- He works hard, doesn't he?
- 'Is your son married?' 'Yes, he is.'
- 'He took the money.' 'No, he didn't'


